

Canning vegetables - participant handout

Follow along - take notes - take it home

Today we are PRESSURE canning vegetables. Vegetables are low-acid foods, so a boiling water bath is not safe - only a pressure canner gets hot enough (about 240 F) to destroy the spores that cause botulism. Use only tested times and pressures.

Canner pressure by altitude and gauge type

Gauge	Altitude	Pressure
Weighted gauge	Sea level to 1,000 feet	10 lb
Weighted gauge	Above 1,000 feet	15 lb
Dial gauge	Sea level to 2,000 feet	11 lb
Dial gauge	2,001-4,000 feet	12 lb
Dial gauge	4,001-6,000 feet	13 lb
Dial gauge	6,001-8,000 feet	14 lb

Set the pressure for YOUR gauge type and YOUR altitude. Most of Oregon's Willamette Valley is at or below 1,000 ft. Source: PNW 172 Canning vegetables.

Worked example - green beans

This is the one example we show today. It is here so you can see how the chart works - not a substitute for looking up your own vegetable

Pack	Pint	Quart
Hot pack	20 min	25 min
Raw pack	20 min	25 min

Source: SP 50 445 Preserving green italian or wax beans. Process at the pressure from the table above.

Every other vegetable - use the tested chart

Important

Exact processing time depends on the vegetable, jar size, and pack. Always read it from the tested chart for that specific vegetable in PNW 172 Canning Vegetables (or the USDA Complete Guide to Home Canning). Never memorize or guess a time, and never shorten one.

Headspace

1 inch headspace for canned vegetables (PNW 172 Canning vegetables).

Hot pack vs raw pack

- Hot pack: Cover the beans with boiling water and boil for 5 minutes. Pack hot beans loosely in jars. Add salt if desired. Cover with boiling water, leaving 1 inch headspace. Remove air bubbles, wipe rims, adjust lids and process in a pressure canner.
- Raw pack: Pack beans tightly into jars. Add salt if desired. Cover beans with boiling water, leaving 1 inch headspace. Remove air bubbles, wipe rims, adjust lids and process in a pressure canner.
- Hot pack: Cover peas with boiling water, bring to a boil and boil 2 minutes. Fill pint or quart jars loosely with hot peas and cooking liquid, leaving 1 inch headspace. Add salt if desired. Remove air bubbles, wipe rims, adjust lids and process in a pressure canner.
- Raw pack: Pack raw peas loosely into hot pint or quart jars, leaving 1 inch headspace. Add salt if desired. Fill jars with boiling water leaving 1 inch headspace. Remove air bubbles, wipe rims, adjust lids and process in a pressure canner.

Notes

Canning vegetables - participant handout (cont.)

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Take home

- OSU Extension food preservation: extension.oregonstate.edu/mfp
- Ask the MFP app your preservation questions anytime.

Sources

Every value above is drawn from these OSU/USDA Extension publications. Verify against the cited source before public use.

- PNW 172 Canning vegetables
- PNW 300 Canning tomatoes and tomato products
- SP 50 305 Preserving peas edible pea pods
- SP 50 443 Preserving corn
- SP 50 445 Preserving green italian or wax beans